

AI Cupid: Genius or "Chatfishing"? — Presenter Briefing Note

3Music TV Prep Sheet

1. The Core Concept (Define It Simply)

Chatfishing = using AI to help write, polish, or entirely generate your messages to a romantic interest — pick-up lines, bio rewrites, witty comebacks — so the "you" your match is falling for is partly (or mostly) machine-authored.

It's the evolution of catfishing: catfishing fakes the *identity*, chatfishing fakes the *personality*. The face is real, the person is real — but the charm might not be.

Easy on-air line: *"You're not lying about who you are. You're lying about how quick-witted you are."*

2. The Numbers (grounded, citable stats)

- A Match/Kinsey Institute survey found **26% of U.S. singles now use AI to enhance their dating lives** — a **333% jump** year-over-year.
- A 2025 Norton study found **6 in 10 dating app users believe they've encountered at least one AI-written conversation.**
- Breaking down *how* singles use it (Match/Kinsey data): **40%** would use AI to write the "perfect" profile, **41%** would let it generate opening lines, and **44%** want AI to screen/filter matches for compatibility before they even swipe.
- The **Rizz** app alone drew roughly **1.5 million monthly active users** and around **20,000 daily downloads** at its peak — enough to rank among the top dating-adjacent apps in the US App Store.

- A newer app, **SmoothRizz**, published real usage data from ~4,400 sessions: users **rejected 80% of AI-generated suggestions** before sending and made **38,000+ tone adjustments** — suggesting people use AI more as a *draft assistant* than a full autopilot. The most common use case was "recovering from a dry/boring conversation," not starting from scratch.
- Interesting nuance: an AXE-linked study found AI-assisted openers get a higher initial response rate (~60% vs ~48% for average human openers) — **but that advantage disappears once conversations move toward commitment/meeting up**, which is exactly where "chatfishing" gets exposed.
- On detection: people are barely better than a coin flip at telling human from AI text. One frequently cited figure: humans were only about **57% accurate** in spotting AI-written text; in a separate 2025 head-to-head chat study, judges mistook GPT-4.5 for a human **73% of the time**.

Africa/Ghana angle: Sagaci Research surveyed over 13,500 adults across 27 African countries and found **28% have used a dating app**, with Tinder and Badoo leading continent-wide, and Bumble notably popular in **Ghana and Uganda**. Interestingly, most Africans on dating apps say they're primarily there for friendship (43%) or curiosity (35%) rather than strictly romance — worth noting as a cultural contrast to the Western "AI wingman" panic. AI-driven matchmaking (behavioral matching, profile optimization tools) is being marketed locally too, though adoption data specific to AI-assisted chatting in Ghana is still thin — this is a good point to editorialize on rather than over-cite.

3. The Apps/Tech to Name-Drop

App	What it does
Rizz	Upload a screenshot of a match's profile or chat; it generates openers and follow-up replies. ~1.5M MAU.
Winggg / YourMove AI	Similar "wingman" tools — YourMove's tagline is literally "puts your texting on cruise control."
SmoothRizz	Newer entrant, browser + iOS, markets itself on tone-sliders (playful/bold/casual) and screenshot-to-reply generation.
Casanova / Wingman AI	Positioned as always-on "AI wingman," similar screenshot-analysis model.

App	What it does
Hinge / Facebook Dating	Mainstream platforms now baking in official AI prompt-coaching rather than leaving it to third-party apps.
"Red flag" analyzer apps (Flagz, Red Flag AI, Lucen, Crush Analyzer)	The <i>other half</i> of the trend — instead of generating your messages, these analyze a match's messages for tone, gaslighting, love-bombing, and attachment style, producing a "toxicity score" people screenshot and share on social media.

Good visual contrast for your graphics team: a generic human opener ("hey, how's it going") next to an AI-generated one that references specific details from a profile — that's the "Rizz-on-Demand" effect the segment description wants.

4. The "Personality Plagiarism" Trap — Talking Points

- The risk isn't just embarrassment — it's a **mismatch of expectations**. If someone falls for a version of you that's 30% ChatGPT, the real-life you has to perform to a standard you didn't set.
- Anecdotal but widely reported pattern (multiple outlets, no hard study yet): people describe matches who were "engaging and witty over text, but boring in person" — the classic tell.
- No peer-reviewed study yet proves chatfishers get *more* dates — only that they get more *engagement*. Worth being honest on air that the "genius hack" claim is unproven; it's optimizing for the swipe/reply, not necessarily the relationship.
- The reverse-trend to flag: **1 in 5 singles report having ghosted someone specifically because they suspected AI was writing the other person's messages** (Vice-reported survey figure) — so there's real social cost to being caught, not just a punchline.

5. AI as "Relationship Therapist" — Talking Points

- People are pasting WhatsApp/DM screenshots into general chatbots (ChatGPT etc.) *and* into dedicated apps built exactly for this (Flagz, Lucen, Red Flag AI) to get an instant "attachment style" or "red flag" reading on a crush or partner.
 - These apps explicitly market themselves as **entertainment/self-reflection tools, not therapy** — most bury a disclaimer saying they're not diagnostic or a substitute for a real therapist. Good tension to raise on air: people are treating a novelty app's output as gospel about someone else's psychology.
 - Ethical wrinkle worth raising: this involves feeding a **third person's private messages** into an AI system without their consent — a consent/privacy angle that's genuinely under-discussed.
 - Real behavioral pattern: it functions like a "toxicity score" you can screenshot and share with friends or post — it's become a social/viral format (see: "Toxic Card" features), which changes the incentive from "understand my relationship" to "get a shareable verdict."
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6. Real-Life Story Angles You Can Use

1. **The Rizz founder story:** Roman Khaves (Rizz co-founder) has spoken publicly about building the app after seeing friends struggle with "dating app fatigue" — describes it as giving people "a strategy" and "confidence" rather than doing the talking for them. Good soundbite if you want the founder's defense on air.
 2. **The mismatch anecdote:** Multiple outlets (Scientific American, Medium/CustomAI) cite daters who match with someone charming over text who turns out flat in person — frame this as a relatable, low-stakes "we've all sort of had this" story rather than needing a named case.
 3. **The ghosting-for-suspicion angle:** People now ghost matches specifically because a message felt "too polished" or generic-AI — flip side of the "genius hack" framing, good for the poll debate.
 4. **The screenshot-economy angle:** The rise of "toxic score" sharing culture — people posting their AI-generated red-flag reports to Stories/TikTok as content, not just private reflection. Strong visual/social-media hook for your production team.
 5. **Local/Ghanaian framing:** Sagaci's finding that most African dating app users are there for friendship/curiosity rather than romance is a good on-air pivot — you can ask panel guests whether "chatfishing" even lands the same way in a market where dating apps aren't primarily viewed as romance-hunting tools.
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7. Suggested On-Air Structure

1. Open with the term + simple definition (30 sec)
 2. Drop 2-3 headline stats (26% usage, 333% jump, the "57% accuracy" detection stat) — these are the ones producers can pull as lower-third graphics
 3. Name the apps (Rizz, Winggg, YourMove) + show the mock opener comparison graphic
 4. Pivot to the "attachment style" surveillance-of-your-crush angle — this is the most conversation-provoking segment
 5. Land on the open question: is it a **hack** (get past the awkward opener) or a **dealbreaker** (you're not actually getting to know the person)? Launch the poll here.
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8. Honest Caveats to Keep You Credible On-Air

- There's **no solid study yet** proving AI-assisted daters get more real dates or better relationships — only more engagement/replies. Don't overstate the "genius" side.
 - Detection stats (57%, 73%) come from different studies with different methodologies (general text vs. live chat) — cite them as "around half to two-thirds," not as if it's one clean number.
 - The red-flag/attachment-style apps are self-described entertainment tools — flag this so you're not on air treating an app's "diagnosis" as clinical fact.
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9. DEEPFAKES — The Escalation Beyond Chatfishing

Chatfishing fakes your *wit*. Deepfakes fake your *entire existence*. This is the natural "next level" beat for the segment — where it stops being a cute dating hack and becomes fraud.

How it's being used right now:

- **AI-generated profile photos** — tools like Midjourney/Stable Diffusion create fully synthetic faces that don't belong to any real person, so a reverse-image search comes back clean. The old advice ("just reverse-image-search their photo") is now unreliable.
- **Real-time face-swap video calls** — scammers run consumer-grade face-swap software live during a video call, mirroring their real expressions onto a fake face. The old "just ask for a video call to prove they're real" test **no longer works**.
- **AI voice cloning** — synthetic voices now run in real time on the same call, so the voice matches the fake face.
- **"Agentic" scam operations** — the newest wrinkle: AI agents now handle entire relationships semi-autonomously — scheduling messages, adjusting tone/timing, even triggering the deepfake call at the right emotional moment — meaning one scammer can run many "relationships" at once with minimal manual effort.

The money numbers (good for graphics):

- US FTC data: romance scam losses were **roughly 1.14–1.16 billion** * **in recent reporting periods, with a* * **median loss of about 2,000 per victim* — the highest median loss of any imposter-scam category the FTC tracks.
- FBI IC3 separately reported **roughly \$929 million** in confidence/romance fraud losses in a recent year.
- Industry fraud-detection firm BioCatch reported financial institutions saw a **63% increase in romance-scam attempts** between 2024 and 2025, attributing it directly to generative AI tools.
- **Real case:** an elderly woman in Scotland was reportedly defrauded of **£17,000** after scammers convinced her (using deepfake-supported storytelling) to buy Steam gift cards.
- **"Pig butchering" / romance-baiting:** the scam that combines a fake romance with a fake crypto "investment platform" — victims are shown fabricated profits to encourage bigger deposits before discovering they can't withdraw anything. This is one of the fastest-growing hybrid scams tied to AI-run romance bots.

How to spot a live deepfake video call (great for an on-screen graphic/checklist):

- Ask them to turn their head to the side (profile view) — many real-time face-swap tools distort or glitch on side angles.
- Ask them to place a hand over part of their face, or move quickly — deepfakes struggle with fast, unpredictable movement and occlusion.

- Watch for lighting inconsistencies between the face and the rest of the video, or lag between lip movement and audio.
 - Ask an unpredictable, specific question about their claimed surroundings/city and cross-check details.
 - The **hard rule that solves 90% of this regardless of how convincing the tech gets: never send money to someone you haven't met in person** — no exceptions, no matter how "real" they seem on a call.
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10. Live AI Chats — AI "Companions" and AI Girlfriend/Boyfriend Apps

This is the other frontier: instead of AI helping you talk to a *human*, people are now having entire romantic relationships *with* the AI itself.

Scale of the trend:

- The number of AI companion apps grew by roughly **700% between 2022 and mid-2025**.
- One 2026 report put usage at nearly **80% of adults aged 18–34 in the US/UK** having used an AI chatbot for companionship at least once.
- Common Sense Media found **72% of US teenagers** have used AI for companionship in some form.
- Roughly **40% of AI companion users** cite it as filling an emotional-support role, and a notable share self-identify as having mental health challenges — this is a genuine wellbeing story, not just a novelty one.

The main platforms to name:

- **Replika** — the longest-running (since 2017), over 10 million+ users historically. Offers Friend / Romantic Partner (paid) / Mentor modes, with memory that builds over months, plus voice calling.
- **Character.AI** — the largest by usage (20M+ monthly users at points), millions of user-created "characters," but built for dialogue/character consistency rather than factual accuracy or persistent memory.
- **Nomi, Kindroid, Candy AI, CrushOn.AI** — newer, more explicitly "AI girlfriend/boyfriend"-branded apps, some with NSFW/roleplay tiers.

The serious controversy to raise (handle carefully, factually):

- Character.AI faced a widely reported lawsuit after a Florida mother alleged her 14-year-old son died by suicide following extended conversations with a Character.AI chatbot persona; the company disputed aspects of the framing and has since added teen safety features (time limits, restricted content for under-18s, crisis-resource prompts when suicide-related topics come up). As of reporting, litigation/settlement discussions were ongoing.
- Separately, Replika's maker was fined roughly **€5 million by Italy's data protection authority (GDPR)** over data handling and inadequate protections, including for minors.
- US senators have publicly demanded information from AI companion companies about safety practices for younger users.

Framing for the show: the honest tension here isn't "is this cheating on a human" — it's that these apps are commercially built to **maximize time-in-app and emotional attachment**, the same engagement incentives as social media, applied to something as intimate as a relationship. That's worth saying plainly rather than played for laughs.

11. New/Emerging Technologies Worth Naming On-Air

- **Real-time face-swap + voice-clone stacks** — no longer niche; runs on a laptop or a couple of phones, no special hardware needed.
- **AI image detectors / deepfake scanners** — a growing consumer counter-industry (apps that let you upload a photo/video/voice clip and get a "likely AI-generated" score) — worth mentioning as the emerging *defense* technology, not just the offense.
- **"Proof of life" verification tech** — some platforms are experimenting with biometric/liveness checks (similar to banking KYC) specifically to counter deepfake dating scams.
- **Agentic AI relationship-runners** — AI systems that don't just draft one message but manage an entire ongoing relationship's timing, tone, and escalation autonomously — the line between "wingman app" and "autonomous scam operator" is now mostly about *intent*, not capability.
- **Voice-calling companion features** — AI companion apps (Replika, Nomi) now offer natural-sounding voice calls with your AI partner, not just text — blurring the line between "chatbot" and "phone relationship."

One clean line to close this expanded segment: *"A year ago the concern was whether your match's opening line was written by AI. Now the question is whether your match — voice, face, and all — exists at all."*